

Sphamandla Xaba — Product Designer & AI Experience Designer

Designing intelligent products, enterprise software, and premium digital experiences that solve real business problems.

1. IDENTITY

Name

Sphamandla Xaba

Primary Positioning

Product Designer

Specialization

Designing enterprise SaaS products, AI-powered experiences, and premium digital interfaces through product thinking, interaction design, and modern web technologies.

Rather than viewing design as creating beautiful screens, I believe design is the process of understanding people, business goals, and systems before creating a single interface.

The interface is the outcome.

The thinking is the product.

2. PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I am a Product Designer based in Gauteng, South Africa, focused on designing enterprise software, AI-powered experiences, and digital products that help businesses work smarter.

My work sits at the intersection of:

- Product Strategy
- User Experience Design
- Interaction Design
- Design Systems
- AI Experience Design
- Motion & Storytelling
- Enterprise SaaS

I believe great products are built by understanding people before designing interfaces.

As artificial intelligence becomes increasingly capable of generating interfaces in seconds, the competitive advantage of designers is no longer how quickly they can produce screens—but how well they define problems, simplify complexity, and create experiences people trust.

That philosophy drives every project I work on.

3. DESIGN PHILOSOPHY

Thinking Before Designing

Every successful product begins long before opening Figma.

Before creating interfaces I ask:

- What problem are we solving?
- Who are we solving it for?
- Why does this problem exist?
- How do users currently work?
- What business outcome matters most?

Only after understanding those questions do I begin designing.

Because products fail long before pixels fail.

Product Design Over Screen Design

Beautiful interfaces do not automatically create successful products.

Product design requires understanding:

- User behaviour
- Business objectives
- Operational workflows
- Technical constraints
- Human psychology
- Decision-making

My role is not simply to make software look modern.

It is to make software work naturally.

AI Accelerates Execution — Not Thinking

Artificial Intelligence has transformed how products are built.

Today AI can generate:

- Wireframes
- UI layouts
- Components
- Design systems
- Code

within minutes.

But AI cannot replace:

- Product strategy
- Human judgement
- Research synthesis
- Prioritisation
- Stakeholder alignment
- Experience architecture

The future belongs to designers who know how to combine AI with strong product thinking—not replace one with the other.

4. MY DESIGN PRINCIPLES

Every project I design is guided by five principles.

1. Clarity

Complex systems should feel simple.

Users should never wonder what happens next.

2. Trust

Every interaction should build confidence.

Especially when designing products involving finance, enterprise operations, or AI.

3. Efficiency

Every unnecessary click costs time.

Every unnecessary decision creates friction.

Good UX removes both.

4. Business Alignment

Every interface should contribute toward measurable business outcomes.

Good design improves:

- adoption
 - retention
 - efficiency
 - conversions
 - satisfaction
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5. Delight Through Motion

Motion should never exist purely for decoration.

Animation should:

- explain
- guide
- reinforce hierarchy
- communicate state
- create memorable experiences

This principle has become increasingly important in my recent work, where I explore cinematic interaction design using technologies such as GSAP, Three.js, and modern web animation.

5. SOUTH AFRICA-FIRST PRODUCT DESIGN

Most digital products are designed for North American or European users first.

I believe products built for South Africa require different assumptions.

My approach is built around five realities.

WhatsApp First

For millions of South Africans, WhatsApp is not a support channel.

It is the primary digital platform.

Products should integrate naturally into that behaviour.

Multilingual Experiences

Language should improve usability rather than become a barrier.

Designing for South Africa means considering multiple languages from the beginning—not as an afterthought.

Data-Conscious Design

Heavy websites and unnecessary downloads have real financial costs.

Performance is not simply technical optimisation.

It is accessibility.

Connectivity Awareness

Users frequently move between strong and weak network conditions.

Products should remain resilient under unreliable connectivity.

Trust in Digital Services

Many users are still cautious when sharing information online.

Clear communication, transparency, and thoughtful UX reduce uncertainty and encourage adoption.

6. AREAS OF EXPERTISE

Product Design

- Product strategy
 - Information architecture
 - User flows
 - Journey mapping
 - Wireframing
 - Prototyping
 - UX validation
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Enterprise SaaS

Designing software for internal teams including:

- Operations
 - HR
 - Asset Management
 - Field Services
 - Administration
 - Business Intelligence
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AI Experience Design

Designing products that responsibly integrate AI through:

- Conversational interfaces
 - AI-assisted workflows
 - Human-in-the-loop interactions
 - Trust-building UX
 - Prompt-driven experiences
 - AI transparency
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Interaction Design

Designing interfaces that feel responsive and intuitive using:

- Motion principles
 - Micro-interactions
 - Scroll storytelling
 - State transitions
 - Progressive disclosure
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Design Systems

Creating scalable systems that improve consistency across large software products.

Including:

- Components
 - Tokens
 - Accessibility
 - Documentation
 - Interaction patterns
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7. TECHNICAL TOOLKIT

Design

- Figma
 - FigJam
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Frontend Collaboration

- HTML
 - CSS
 - Tailwind CSS
 - React fundamentals
 - Next.js fundamentals
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Motion & Interaction

- GSAP
 - Framer Motion
 - Lenis
 - React Three Fiber
 - Three.js
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AI Workflow

- Claude Code
- ChatGPT

- Cursor
- GitHub Copilot

Using AI to accelerate ideation, documentation, prototyping, and implementation while maintaining human-led product thinking.

8. SELECTED WORK

GEM Information Systems (Current)

Product Designer contributing to enterprise software and digital transformation initiatives.

Key contributions include:

- Enterprise website redesign
 - SaaS platform improvements
 - UX strategy
 - Design systems
 - Product workflows
 - Interaction design
 - Motion direction
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ManaGem

Enterprise SaaS platform focused on business operations.

Contributions include:

- End-to-end UX
 - Dashboard redesign
 - Information architecture
 - Workflow optimisation
 - Design system development
 - Enterprise UI
 - Product strategy
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WasteMart

Designed field verification experiences supporting operational workflows.

Focus areas:

- Mobile-first UX
 - Verification processes
 - User flows
 - Operational efficiency
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NeuraCalm (Concept)

An AI-powered financial coaching concept exploring conversational AI, trust, behavioural design, and financial wellbeing.

This project demonstrates product thinking, systems design, and AI experience principles rather than representing a shipped product.

Personal Portfolio

Currently evolving from a traditional WordPress portfolio into a modern cinematic experience using React, Three.js, GSAP, and immersive interaction design to demonstrate not only visual design capability but also frontend collaboration and experience craftsmanship.

9. PERSONAL BRANDS

NeuraUX

A product design studio focused on AI-powered digital experiences.

Mission:

Helping organisations design intelligent products that people understand, trust, and enjoy using.

Focus areas include:

- AI UX
 - Product Strategy
 - Design Systems
 - Enterprise Software
 - Conversational Experiences
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AX-Channels

A digital studio helping South African SMEs establish professional online presences through high-quality websites and digital experiences.

10. WHO I WANT TO WORK WITH

I enjoy solving complex problems for organisations building products that improve how people work.

Industries of interest include:

- Financial Services
 - Enterprise SaaS
 - PropTech
 - HealthTech
 - AI Platforms
 - Productivity Software
 - Public Sector Digital Services
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11. LONG-TERM VISION

My ambition is to become one of Africa's leading Product Designers specialising in enterprise software and AI-powered experiences.

Over the next several years I aim to deepen my expertise across:

- Product Strategy
- AI Experience Design
- Design Systems

- Motion Design
- Human-Centred AI
- Enterprise UX
- Frontend Collaboration

while helping organisations build software that is not only functional but intuitive, trustworthy, and genuinely valuable.

12. PERSONAL MANIFESTO

Technology will continue to evolve.

AI will continue to generate interfaces.

Code will become easier to write.

Design tools will become smarter.

But businesses will always need people who can ask better questions, simplify complexity, and design experiences that improve how humans work.

That is the designer I strive to become.

I don't design screens.

I design understanding.

And when people understand, businesses grow.